



PickMyPlate

PRODUCT OVERVIEW

Every child can choose their own lunch

A picture-based, read-aloud lunch ordering system for SEND schools, with allergy-safe diet cards, class logins and live orders for the kitchen.

**PickMyPlate**
Picture-based lunch choices for SEND schools

AA Sign out

SCHOOL A · AA · THURSDAY

DIET CARD

No card

Blue · No milk

Yellow · No eggs

Purple · No gluten

Orange · No nuts or sesame

Teal · No fish or shellfish

Pink · No soya

Green · Vegetarian

Now: Main

Sides

Dessert

All done

What would you like for your main?



Jacket potato



Sandwich



Burger and wedges



Veggie burger and wedges

I choose Jacket potato

 Say it

Version

1.0 (online, multi-school)

Date

24 September 2026

Works on

Tablets, computers and phones

Price

Free to use

WHAT IT IS

What PickMyPlate does

In SEND schools, many children are autistic, non-verbal, or not yet reading, so a written menu doesn't work for them. PickMyPlate shows the day's menu as **large real food photos**, **reads each choice aloud**, and takes the child through one simple step at a time. Every order goes straight to the kitchen, labelled with its school and class.

Classes

Sign in once on the class tablet and see only the lunch screen. Children choose, the order is sent.

Kitchen manager

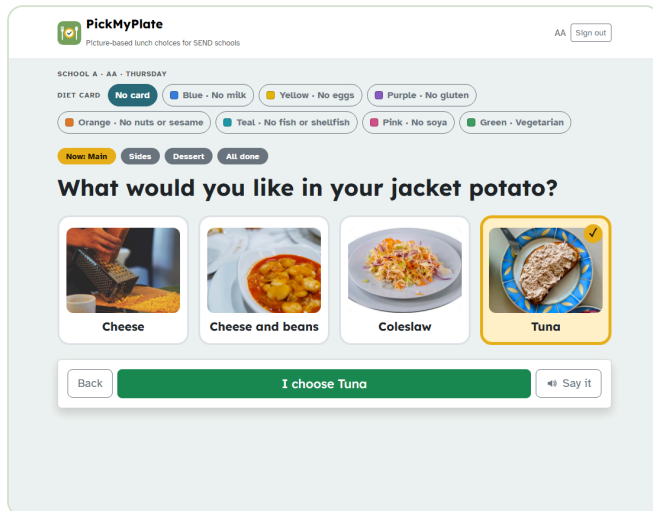
Sees live orders for every school and class, manages the menu, allergens, diet cards, schools and class logins.

Features

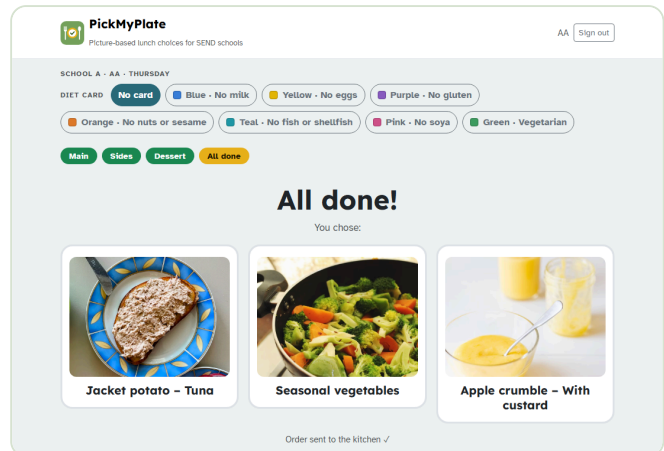
Feature	What it does
Real food photos	Every dish and filling has a clear photo, all shown at the same size. The kitchen manager can replace any photo with one of the school's own food.
Read aloud	Tapping a picture says its name, so children who can't read still know exactly what they're choosing.
Now and Next steps	Main → Sides → Dessert of the day → All done, one step at a time.
Choices inside a dish	Jacket potato and sandwich fillings, burger types, and custard or no custard, all chosen from photos.
Diet cards	Seven colour-coded cards (e.g. <i>Blue · No milk</i> , <i>Green · Vegetarian</i>) hide anything unsafe. Cards use colours, never names.
The school's real menu	The 3-week rotating menu with the UK's 14 allergens. It moves on to the next week automatically every Monday.
Live orders	Totals for each school and combined, meals to prepare, and a serving list for every class.
Secure logins	Each class has its own login. Only the kitchen manager can change the menu, schools and classes.

Choose lunch

After the class signs in, children see only this screen: no menus, settings or distractions.



Choices inside a dish. After choosing a jacket potato, the child picks a filling from photos.



All done. The full meal is shown and read aloud, and the order is sent to the kitchen.

How to use it

- 1 **Pick a diet card (adult)**, if the child has one. Unsafe dishes and fillings disappear automatically.
- 2 **Choose a main (child)**. Tap a photo: it lights up with a tick and is read aloud. "Say it" repeats it.
- 3 **Confirm** with the green "I choose..." button, then pick a filling if the dish has one.
- 4 **Sides**: vegetables or salad, or "No thank you".
- 5 **Dessert of the day**: the day's dessert or fruit, with or without custard.
- 6 **All done**. The order is sent. The adult taps "Next child" to reset the screen.

Diet cards

Before a child with a dietary need chooses, the adult taps their diet card. PickMyPlate then shows only the dishes and fillings that are safe for that card.

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AA [Sign out](#)

SCHOOL A · AA · THURSDAY

DIET CARD

No card

Blue · No milk

Yellow · No eggs

Purple · No gluten

Orange · No nuts or sesame

Teal · No fish or shellfish

Pink · No soya

Green · Vegetarian

Now: Main

Sides

Dessert

All done

What would you like for your main?


Jacket potato

Tap a picture to choose.

With **Purple · No gluten** selected, only the jacket potato is shown. The sandwich and burgers contain gluten, so they are hidden.

Card	Hides anything containing
Blue · No milk	Milk
Yellow · No eggs	Eggs
Purple · No gluten	Gluten (wheat, barley, oats, rye)
Orange · No nuts or sesame	Peanuts, tree nuts, sesame
Teal · No fish or shellfish	Fish, crustaceans, molluscs
Pink · No soya	Soya
Green · Vegetarian	Anything that isn't vegetarian

More cards can be added, e.g. a combined card for a child with several allergies. **Safety rule:** a dish whose allergens haven't been confirmed by the kitchen manager is always hidden from every diet card.

Orders

Orders arrive live for each school and in total, with exactly what to prepare and a serving list for every class.

**PickMyPlate**
Picture-based lunch choices for SEND schools

Orders

Kitchen menu

Schools & classes

Preview

Kitchen manager

Sign out

ORDERS FOR

09/24/2026

Thursday 24 September · updates live

10

TOTAL

6

SCHOOL A

4

SCHOOL B

All schools

School A

School B

Meals to prepare

Meal	School A	School B	Total
Main			
Jacket potato – Tuna	1	1	2
Burger and wedges – Chicken burger	2		2
Burger and wedges – Beef burger	1	1	2
Veggie burger and wedges	1	1	2
Jacket potato – Coleslaw	1		1
Jacket potato – Cheese		1	1
Sides			
Seasonal vegetables	4	2	6
Mixed salad	2	1	3
No thank you		1	1
Dessert			
Fruit	3	2	5
Apple crumble – With custard	2	2	4
Apple crumble – No custard	1		1

Serving list by class

School A

AA

4 orders

MAIN

1 × Jacket potato – Tuna

1 × Burger and wedges – Chicken burger

1 × Burger and wedges – Beef burger

1 × Jacket potato – Coleslaw

SIDES

3 × Seasonal vegetables

1 × Mixed salad

DESSERT

2 × Apple crumble – With custard

2 × Fruit

Diet card meals: keep separate

• Blue • No milk: Jacket potato – Coleslaw, Seasonal vegetables, Fruit

► Individual orders

BB

2 orders

MAIN

1 × Veggie burger and wedges

1 × Burger and wedges – Chicken burger

SIDES

1 × Mixed salad

1 × Seasonal vegetables

DESSERT

1 × Apple crumble – No custard

1 × Fruit

► Individual orders

Example data. Meals ordered with a diet card are listed separately, in yellow, so they're kept apart. Mistaken orders can be removed.

Any past date can be viewed.

Kitchen menu

The whole menu is managed here: dishes, photos, fillings, allergens, dietary tags, diet cards and the menu rotation.

PickMyPlate
Picture-based lunch choices for SEND schools

Orders **Kitchen menu** Schools & classes Preview Kitchen manager Sign out

Menu: Week 1, Thursday

Week 1 Week 2 Week 3 Mon Tue Wed **Thu** Fri

SHOW All dishes Blue - No milk Yellow - No eggs Purple - No gluten Orange - No nuts or sesame Teal - No fish or shellfish Pink - No soya Green - Vegetarian Vegan Halal

Showing 7 of 8 dishes that suit **Green - Vegetarian**. Choices that don't suit it are crossed out.

MAIN - 3 DISHES

Jacket potato Every day
Choices: Cheese, Cheese and beans, Coleslaw, Tuna
Allergen notes: Plain potato has no listed allergens. Butter or spread adds milk (and sometimes soya). Coleslaw and tuna mayo contain egg and usually mustard (mayonnaise).
Vegetarian

Sandwich Every day
Choices: Cheese, Turkey Ham, Jam
Allergen notes: Bread contains wheat; many UK sliced breads also contain soya flour and may contain sesame traces. Butter or spread adds milk.
Gluten Soya Vegetarian

Veggie burger and wedges Week 1 - Thursday
Allergen notes: Bun contains wheat and often sesame and soya. Veggie burgers vary widely: some contain egg, milk, celery or mustard. Check the brand.
Gluten Soya Sesame Vegetarian

SIDES - 2 DISHES

Seasonal vegetables Every day
Allergen notes: Plain vegetables have no listed allergens, but celery IS one of the 14 allergens. If celery is in the mix, add it. Butter glaze adds milk.
Vegetarian Vegan

Mixed salad Every day
Allergen notes: Plain salad has no listed allergens. Dressings often contain mustard and sulphites (vinegar); celery in the

Menu rotation

This week (starting 21 September) is:

Week 1 Week 2 Week 3

Moves on automatically every Monday, for every school.

Diet cards

Staff pick a card before a child chooses. Dishes that aren't safe for that card are hidden.

Blue - No milk Edit Remove
No milk
7 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Yellow - No eggs Edit Remove
No eggs
8 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Purple - No gluten Edit Remove
No gluten
4 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Orange - No nuts or sesame Edit Remove
No peanuts No tree nuts
No sesame
6 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Teal - No fish or shellfish Edit Remove
No fish No crustaceans
No molluscs
8 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Pink - No soya Edit Remove
No soya
5 of 8 dishes shown on this day

Green - Vegetarian Edit Remove
Vegetarian only
7 of 8 dishes shown on this day

"Show" filter buttons display the dishes that suit each diet card. Fillings that don't suit it are crossed out.

- **Add or edit a dish:** name, step, week and day, photo (or emoji), allergens, tags, choices inside the dish (each with its own photo) and allergen notes.
- **Menu rotation:** set which week of the 3-week menu it is once. It then moves on by itself every Monday.
- **Read aloud** can be switched on or off for every class device.

Schools, classes and security



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Orders

Kitchen menu

Schools & classes

Preview

Kitchen manager

Sign out

Schools & classes

Add a school

Each class gets its own login. Class devices can only choose lunch, and every order is labelled with its school and class.

School A2 classes

Rename

Remove

Add a class

AA

Username: a-aa

Edit

Remove

BB

Username: a-bb

Edit

Remove

School B2 classes

Rename

Remove

Add a class

CC

Username: b-cc

Edit

Remove

DD

Username: b-dd

Edit

Remove

Removing a class or giving it a new login blocks the old login straight away. To tidy up, you can also delete old logins in Firebase → Authentication.

Add schools and classes, and create or replace class logins.

Area	How it works
Class logins	Each class has its own username and password. Forgotten passwords are replaced instantly, and the old login stops working.
What classes can do	Choose lunch and send orders for their own class only. They can't see other orders or change anything.
Kitchen manager	One manager login controls the menu, schools, classes and orders.
No children's names	Orders store only the school, class, meal and diet card colour.
Data in the UK	Stored in Google Firebase's London data centre, protected by security rules.

How it's built

Part	Technology
Pages and design	HTML5, Bootstrap 5.3 and custom CSS. Works on tablets, phones and computers, with dark mode.
Behaviour	Plain JavaScript
Logins and database	Google Firebase (Authentication and Firestore), London region, with security rules
Read aloud	The browser's built-in speech (British English)
Hosting	GitHub Pages
Photos	Unsplash (free licence), replaceable with the school's own photos

Roadmap

Stage	Plan
Now	Live for School A and School B. Pilot with one class in each school, and gather feedback.
Next	Install on class tablets like an app. Printable picture menus for classrooms.
Then	Texture levels for children with swallowing difficulties. Menus in other languages.
Later	Allergen suggestions to help staff (always confirmed by a person). Versions for children's homes.

Try it

<https://usmanbabardev.github.io/pickmyplate/>

Access is login-only. Ask the kitchen manager for a demo class login.